

A SELF-GUIDED RESET · FROM SOMEONE WHO'S WALKED IT

The 90-Day Brain Reset

Quit the unwanted habit, break the loop, and get your drive back — one honest day at a time.

Works for any compulsive habit: porn, compulsive eating, doomscrolling, the late-night spiral. This is education and companionship, not medical treatment. If you're in crisis, please reach a professional or a helpline — this walks beside that, it doesn't replace it.

If you've tried to quit with willpower and lost, you're not weak. You've been fighting the wrong fight.

You've white-knuckled it. Made the promise on Sunday, broken it by Tuesday, and hated yourself by Wednesday. Then done it again. That cycle isn't a character flaw — it's a trained brain doing exactly what it was trained to do. The good news hiding in that sentence: what got trained can get re-trained. That's what the next 90 days are for.

This isn't about becoming perfect. It's about becoming free — free enough that the habit stops running your day, your focus, and your self-respect.

01 What I believe was happening in my brain

I'm not a doctor — this is the explanation that finally made my 38 years make sense, and it's the one I'll give you.

Every unwanted habit — porn, the binge, the endless scroll — runs on the chase. The pull you feel isn't really about the pleasure; it's the hunt for it, screaming "go get it," and it doesn't care if the thing is good for you.

Modern habits hijack that chase. They deliver a hit bigger, faster, and more novel than ordinary life can compete with. And in my experience, the longer it goes on:

- The habit gives you less (you need more to feel the same).
- Everything else — work, food, real intimacy, a walk — starts to feel flat and gray.
- The urge gets louder even as the payoff gets smaller.

That flatness you feel? That's not "you being lazy or broken." That's what a habit like this does to a man. And here's what I lived: it comes back. The color comes back.

The one idea that changes everything

You are not quitting a pleasure. You are healing a numbed life so that ordinary things feel good again. You're not giving something up — you're getting your color back.

02 The 90-Day Map

Ninety days isn't magic — it's long enough to walk out of the fog and build new grooves. Ask anyone who's done it. We split it into three phases. Each has one job. Don't skip ahead — each phase makes the next one possible.

DAYS 1–30 • DETOX

Break the loop

The only goal here is distance from the habit. No optimizing, no perfection — just don't feed it, and survive the urges. The first ten days are the hardest; the "flatline" (roughly days 10–25) is where most people quit because they feel worse before better. That dip is the healing, not the failure. Expect it, and it can't ambush you.

DAYS 31–60 • REWIRE

Replace the void

A habit isn't just removed — it leaves a hole, and holes get filled by whatever's easiest. This phase you install replacements: what you do instead when the urge hits, and the routines that make the old habit inconvenient. Energy and drive start coming back here. This is where it gets good.

DAYS 61–90 • REBUILD

Become the person who doesn't

By now the urges are quieter and further apart. This phase is about identity: you stop being "someone trying to quit" and start being "someone who just doesn't do that anymore." You build the life that makes the habit irrelevant — real goals, real people, real drive pointed somewhere that matters.

03 The Daily Reset (your one routine)

Complexity is where quitting goes to die. So here's the entire daily practice. Four things. That's it.

- 1 **Morning anchor (2 min).** Before your phone: one glass of water, three slow breaths, and one line — "Today I protect my focus." You win the day in the first five minutes or you lose it.
- 2 **Guard the triggers.** Know your three biggest ones (boredom, loneliness, being alone at night, a certain app). Design them out: phone out of the bedroom, block at the router, don't get to 11pm alone and understimulated.
- 3 **Run the urge protocol when it hits** (next section). Urges are waves. You don't fight a wave — you float over it.
- 4 **Close the day (1 min).** Mark the day done. Note one win and one trigger you noticed. That's the whole journal.

04 The Urge Protocol — S.U.R.F.

The urge feels like an emergency that will last forever. It won't. In my experience an urge peaks and fades in about 15–20 minutes if you don't feed it. You just have to get to the other side of the wave. When it hits, SURF it:

S — Stop & name it. Out loud: "This is an urge. It's a wave. It will pass." Naming it breaks the trance.

U — Unhook the hands. Physically move. Stand up, leave the room, cold water on your face, 20 pushups, step outside. Motion breaks the loop the brain is trying to complete.

R — Ride 15 minutes. Set a timer. You are not saying "never" — you're saying "not for 15 minutes." Anyone can do 15 minutes. The wave will crest and fall inside it.

F — Fill the gap. Do your pre-decided replacement (section 05). The urge left a hole; put something real in it before the habit rushes back.

You never have to quit forever. You only have to get through the next wave. Then the next. Forever takes care of itself.

05 Your 5 tools

1. The Trigger List

Write your top 5 triggers — the exact times, feelings, and places the urge shows up. You can't beat an enemy you won't look at. Most urges come from H.A.L.T.: Hungry, Angry, Lonely, Tired. Circle which one is yours.

2. The Replacement Menu

Pre-decide 5 things you'll do instead — because deciding in the moment always loses. Make them easy and physical: a walk, cold shower, call one person, gym, a specific project. Post it where you'll see it.

3. The Streak

Track days clean. Not for pressure — for proof. Watching the number climb rewires your identity: "I've got 12 days, I'm not throwing that away." A simple calendar with an X per day works.

4. The Nightly Two Lines

"One win today was _____. "One trigger I noticed was _____."

That's the whole journal. Sixty seconds. It turns autopilot into awareness, and awareness is 80% of the battle.

5. The Panic Plan

Write — now, while you're clear — the exact 3 steps you'll take when the urge is at a 10. Example: "1) Leave the room. 2) Text [name] the code word. 3) Walk around the block." Decide it cold so you don't have to decide it hot.

06 When you slip (read this before you need it)

You might slip. Most people do. What decides your outcome isn't whether you fall — it's what you do in the 10 minutes after. **The slip costs you one day. The shame spiral — "I already blew it, might**

as well" — costs you the next thirty. The spiral is the real enemy, not the slip.

The Comeback Protocol

1. **No shame, just data.** Ask "what was the trigger?" — not "what's wrong with me?"
2. **Reset the clock the same hour.** Don't wait for Monday. Your streak restarts now, not in three days of "one last week."
3. **Add the trigger to your list and one new defense.** Every slip that teaches you something isn't a failure — it's tuition.

A relapse isn't the opposite of recovery. Quitting on your recovery is. You have not failed until you stop coming back.

07 Your 90-day checklist

Print this. Cross one off a day. Momentum is built in Xs, not in feelings.

- Wrote my Trigger List & circled my HALT
- Posted my Replacement Menu where I'll see it
- Removed my #1 trigger from my environment (phone out of room / blocker on)
- Wrote my Panic Plan (the 3 cold-decided steps)
- Started my streak calendar
- Did the Morning Anchor & Nightly Two Lines today
- SURFed at least one urge instead of feeding it
- Told one safe person I'm doing this — secrets are where this thing gets its power
- Got through the flatline (days ~10–25) without quitting
- Reached 30 · 60 · 90 — and built the life that makes it irrelevant

You didn't get here overnight, and you won't leave overnight. But 90 days from now you can be a different person — clearer, driven, and finally back in the driver's seat.

Not perfect. Free. That's the whole goal. Start with the next wave. I'm walking it with you.

Want this in your pocket instead of on paper?

I built every tool in this guide into an app — the urge protocol, the panic plan, the streak, the two-line journal — plus a private AI companion for the 2am moments, and a section for the partner that nothing else has. Your 2am conversations are never saved.

Start with the free 2-minute check-in — private, no signup:

www.turnsomedayintodayone.com

The 90-Day Brain Reset · Jacques — Turn Someday Into Day One

Educational and peer-support material — not medical, psychological, or clinical treatment, and not a substitute for professional care. If your habit involves risk of harm to yourself or others, please contact a licensed professional or a crisis line in your country. You deserve real support, and asking for it is strength.